Nimbus Retail Pvt. Ltd. - Employee Handbook 2026

Effective 1 April 2026. This handbook applies to all full-time employees in India. Nimbus Retail is a fictional company created for a capstone demonstration.

1. About Nimbus Retail

Nimbus Retail was founded in 2014 and is headquartered in Pune, Maharashtra. The company operates 86 stores across India and an online store, and employs about 1,240 people. The Chief Executive Officer is Ananya Rao and the Chief People Officer is Vikram Menon.

2. Working hours and hybrid work

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday to Friday, for corporate staff. Corporate teams follow a hybrid model: employees work from the office three days a week (Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday) and may work remotely on Monday and Friday. Employees receive a remote work allowance of INR 2,000 per month to cover internet and electricity costs. Store staff follow shift rosters published two weeks in advance.

3. Leave policy

Full-time employees receive 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued at 2 days per month. A maximum of 10 unused annual leave days can be carried forward into the next year; any balance above 10 days lapses on 31 December. Employees also receive 12 days of paid sick leave per year, which cannot be carried forward. A medical certificate is required for sick leave longer than 2 consecutive days.

Parental leave: birthing parents receive 26 weeks of paid maternity leave. Non-birthing parents receive 15 days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption. Bereavement leave is 5 days for an immediate family member.

Public holidays: the company observes 10 public holidays each year; the list is published in January.

4. Travel and expense policy

All business travel must be approved by the employee's manager before booking. Domestic flights are booked in economy class through the corporate travel desk. International travel requires approval from a Vice President.

Hotel limits per night: INR 6,500 in metro cities (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Pune) and INR 4,500 in non-metro cities. The daily allowance (per diem) for meals and local transport is INR 1,200 per day.

Expense claims must be submitted in the ExpensePro tool within 30 days of the expense, with itemised receipts for any amount above INR 500. Claims above INR 50,000 require Vice President approval in addition to the manager. Approved claims are reimbursed with the next monthly salary.

5. Information security policy

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for email, VPN and all business applications. Passwords are not force-rotated on a schedule, but must be changed immediately if a compromise is suspected.

All company laptops are encrypted (FileVault on macOS, BitLocker on Windows) and managed by IT. Company data must not be stored on personal devices or personal cloud storage. Security incidents, including lost devices and suspected phishing, must be reported to security@nimbusretail.example within 1 hour of discovery.

All employees complete phishing awareness training every quarter, and security policy training once a year. Employees who fail two simulated phishing tests in a row must attend a refresher session.

6. Code of conduct

Employees must avoid conflicts of interest and declare any gift or hospitality received from a vendor or partner valued above INR 5,000 to the Compliance team within 7 days. Cash gifts of any amount may not be accepted.

Concerns about misconduct can be reported confidentially through the Ethics Hotline at ethics@nimbusretail.example. Retaliation against anyone raising a concern in good faith is prohibited.

7. Performance reviews and learning

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October. Every employee has an annual learning budget of INR 25,000 for courses and certifications approved by their manager.

8. Separation

The notice period is 30 days for staff below manager level and 60 days for managers and above. All company equipment must be returned on or before the last working day.